

Conceptual design

- Transform user requirements/needs into a conceptual model
- A conceptual model is an outline of what people can do with a product and what concepts are needed to understand and interact with it
- Mood board may be used to capture feel
- Consider alternatives: prototyping helps

Is there a suitable metaphor?

- Interface metaphors combine familiar knowledge with new knowledge in a way that will help the user understand the product.
- Three steps: understand functionality, identify potential problem areas, generate metaphors
- Evaluate metaphors:
 - How much structure does it provide?
 - How much is relevant to the problem?
 - Is it easy to represent?
 - Will the audience understand it?
 - How extensible is it?

Considering interaction and interface types

- Which interaction type?
 - How the user invokes actions
 - Instructing, conversing, manipulating or exploring
- Do different interface types provide insight?
 - shareable, tangible, augmented reality, etc.

Expanding the initial conceptual model

- What functions will the product perform?
 - What will the product do and what will the human do (task allocation)?
- How are the functions related to each other?
 - Sequential or parallel?
 - Categorisations, e.g. all actions related to privacy on a smartphone
- What information is needed?
 - What data is required to perform the task?
 - How is this data to be transformed by the system?